

The Gathering of the People
First Congregational Church of Los Angeles is a safe place for all people, and we celebrate our diversity of race, creed, age, ability, gender, religion, cultural background, sexual orientation, gender identities and expressions...We extend a warm welcome to all this afternoon and especially those who are with us for the first time. Your presence both enriches us and this time of celebration together ~

Organ Prelude Concert **Dr. Christoph Bull**, *Organist-in-Residence*

Chiming of the Hour

Welcome **Rev. Rachael Pryor**

Let us rise together, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering

***Hymn of Gathering** *Gather Us In*

Here in this place, the new light is streaming,
Shadows of doubt are vanished away.
See in this space our fears and our dreamings,
Brought here to you in the light of this day.
Gather us in, the lost and forsaken;
Gather us in; our spirits inflame.
Call to us now, and we shall awaken;
We shall arise at the sound of our name.

We are the young, our lives are a mystery;
We are the old, who yearn for your face.
We have been sung throughout all of history,
Called to be light to the whole human race.
Gather us in, the rich and the haughty;
Gather us in, the proud and the strong;
Give us a heart so meek and so lowly;
Give us the courage to enter the song.

Here we receive new life in the waters;
Here we receive the bread of new birth;
Here you shall call all of your children,
Call us anew to be salt for the earth.
Give us to drink the cup of compassion,
Give us to eat the bread that is you;
Nourish us well, and teach us to fashion
Lives that are holy and hearts that are true.

Not just in buildings, small and confining,
Not in some heaven light years away,
here in this place the new light is shining;
Now is God present, and now is the day.
Gather us in and hold us forever;
Gather us in and make us your own;
Gather us in, all peoples together,
Fire of love in our flesh and our bone.

***Prayer of Awareness** **Amiah Adamiak**

Holy One, by your grace,
which is and was and ever shall be...
we enter now the sacred realm,
the place of deep connection with you,
with each other, and with all of creation.

By your grace, the walls that isolate fall;
fear dissolves into trust;
arrogance is gentled by compassion;
our need to prove ourselves is tempered
by self-acceptance and humility.

Help us now, Wild and Holy One, to rest in a love
that helps us see our lives
as part of your great unity
and coherence of grace.

We join with all creation in proclaiming
the wonder of the universe,
and the glory of being alive
in this, our time and place.

In the name of the One who shows us the Way, we pray.

May it be so.
May it be so for all of us.
Amen and Amen.

***The Lord’s Prayer**
Our Creator, in heaven, holy be your name.
Your kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as in heaven.
Give us today our daily bread,
And forgive us our sins as we forgive those who sin against us.
Save us from the time of trial, and deliver us from evil,
For the kingdom, the power, and the glory are yours, now and forever. Amen.

Please be seated

Choral Gifts Vai O Le Ola Congregational Choir

Please be seated

Reading from Our Religious Tradition **Dr. Mafutaga Tagaloa-Tulifao**

Mataio 11:1-4
Ua uma ona poloa’i e Iesu i ona so’o e to’asefulu ma le to’alua, ona maliu ese ai lea o ia i lea mea, e a’oa’o atu ma tala’i atu i o latou aai. Ua lagona e Ioane i le fale puipui o galuega a Keriso, ona aauina mai ai lea e ia ni ona so’o se to’alua, ua fa’apea mai ia te ia, “O oe ea le maliu mai, pe matou te fa’atali i se tasi?” Ona tali atu ai lea o Iesu, ua fa’apea atu ia te i laua, “Ina o atu ia oulua, ma fa’aילוa atu ia Ioane o mea na oulua fa’alogo i ai ma vaai i ai.

Ia manuia le faitauina o le Tusi Paia
Ia tumau atu pea iā te ia o le viiga e fa’avavau, fa’avavau lava. Amene

This is the Gospel of Love and Grace.
Thanks be to God!

Sermon **We are the Ones** **Rev. Chrissy Siva**

Meditation Anthem “Song Of Bridgid” LAURA ASH
SCNC Pop-Up Choir, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Soloist*

Installation of SCNC Officers **Rev. Tim Seery, Rev. Dr. Rosario Ibarra & Officers**

Will our newly elected and continuing board members and committee members
please rise in body or in spirit.

Each and every one of you brings diverse gifts to this Conference in the roles you
will fill. Together, you nurture the covenant at the heart of who we are.

Will you approach your service with honesty, openness, and a heart for building
up God’s promised community? If so, say, “I will, by the grace of God.”
(I will, by the grace of God.)

Will you respect the work of each expression of this Conference—local church,
committee, and specialized ministry—serving together in the way of Jesus,
grounded in the knowledge that “we’re the ones” that God has been waiting for?
If so, say, “I will, by the light of Christ.”
(I will, by the light of Christ.)

Will you journey together into an unpredictable future, trusting God’s abun-
dance and faithfully stewarding the relationships, resources, and dreams of
God’s people? If so, say, “I will by the wisdom of the Holy Spirit.”
(I will, by the wisdom of the Holy Spirit.)

Members of the wider church gathered here, will you encourage these lead-
ers, speak truth in love, and celebrate their offerings of service? If so, say,
“we will, with the strength of our covenant.”
(We will, with the strength of our covenant.)

May the blessing of God sustain you through the year to come. Will all
God’s people say Amen?

Celebrating Communion

Words of Invitation

Whether there are 13 people gathered on one side of one long table,
or 56 grouped around tables in the fellowship room, the invitation remains:
All: We are called and welcomed to satisfy our hunger.

Whether there are 5,000 people on a hillside eating from their laps,
or 1 on a couch in the living room eating from a TV table, the invitation
remains:
All: We are called and welcomed to satisfy our thirst.

Whether there are 20 people bumping elbows in a dining hall,
or 6 squatting hip-to-hip around a shared bowl, the invitation remains:
All: We are called and welcomed to satisfy our need for the Bread.

Whether we find ourselves at literal tables of various shapes,
or at some of the many other ways we gather to eat, the invitation remains:
All: We are called and welcomed to satisfy our need for the Cup.

We are invited, once again, to come feast at this sacred table.

Words of Remembrance

And as we do, we remember that final gathering
at that familiar table with Jesus and his friends.
That night started out like many others before
as they shared stories along with the bread and cup,
filling their spirits and bodies with a communal meal.

But this night was different.
Aware of the betrayal that would lead to his death,
Jesus drew meaning from their meal-sharing
so that they – and we! – would always
Remember, even after he was gone.

He took that basic bread,
blessed and broke it, saying,
“This is my body, shared with you.
Every time y’all do this, remember.”

And after they supped,
Jesus blessed and poured that common cup, saying,
“This is the cup of the new covenant, poured for you.
Every time y’all do this, remember.”

In this very hour, we remember:
Jesus invites everyone, table or not.

In this very hour, we remember:
the Church has bread, table or not.

In this very hour, we remember:
all we need is to need the Bread and Cup, table or not.

Invocation of the Spirit
Let us invite the Spirit to visit this meal.

*All: Infuse yourself into each element, Holy One,
so that we can encounter you wholly as one.
When we eat and drink,
give us the wisdom to celebrate
and the courage to embody
the diverse grains and droplets
that form this sacred meal.*

Make us grateful for all we are about to receive,
and unite us in love, now and always. Amen.

Sharing God’s Gifts
At this table we celebrate all the diverse ways we have been created.
Everyone is invited to share in this feast. This afternoon we will receive
communion with gluten free wafers and grape juice. You are invited
to come forward to receive these gifts and then light a candle to signify
the prayers of your heart on this day. As we share this time,
we remember that this is the bread of new life and the cup of hope,
given in love for each of us.

Come and eat. Table or not, all things have been made ready.

Prayer of Thanksgiving
Let us pray together:
*Thank you, Maker and Breaker of Tables,
for inviting me – and us all! –
to partake in this sacred meal.
Even as we have gotten our fill today,
keep our hungers unsatisfied
and our thirsts unquenched
so that we might do and be the Church,
always in remembrance of you. Amen.*

[Communion liturgy adapted: Langeni “Table or Not” in Do This: Communion for Just
and Courageous Living, edited by Mary Luti]

Invitation to Generosity
Rev. Chad Tanaka Pack



Offertory
“Amen”
Conference Choir
KELLY MCCANDLESS

*Doxology
From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator’s praise arise!
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!
[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

*Prayer of Offering
Gracious and Loving God,
on this day we pray
that your Spirit might fill these gifts
we have given, and will give.
Rich Fluechtling

We also ask, Holy One, that we might
be filled and become vessels of your love,
your hope, your joy, and your justice in the world.
Remind us, O God, in these days ahead of us,
that we belong to you and we belong to each other.
We pray this in the name of the One,
who shows us the many paths that lead
to your Divine Presence,
and that flow from our lives through peace.
Amen and Amen!

Please be seated

Choral Response
“Walk In Beauty, Walk In Light”
SCNC Pop-Up Choir, Molly Pease, Soloist
JUDY A. ROSE

Words of Sending
Today, in this place and time,
we rejoice as children of the Divine,
as we celebrate the beauty and worth of all creation.
Rev. Chrissy Siva

*God created us; we are not alone.
God loves us; nothing will separate us from that love.
God frees us; we are free to love indeed!*

Are we the ones ready for the blessing and challenge?
Yes, we are the ones!

May it ever be so.
*May it ever be so for all of us.
Amen and amen!*

*Hymn for the Journey
Come, See the Fullness
God the Creator gave in abundance
All of the wonder we now behold;
Colors of glory, everyday beauty,
Echo the story of God’s deep love.
BUNESSAN

Bold as the sunlight, tender as nightfall,
Love shaped the heav’n’s height; love filled the seas.
Love formed the flowers, called for the living;
Marked out the hours of time to be.

Come, see the fullness – Life we’ve been given;
Beauty and promise, mystr’y and hope.
Laughter and weeping, vision and purpose;
Friends for the keeping, strength for the road.

Open your hearts wide, teach us your wisdom
Lest our days pass by empty and small.
May we be witness with your creation–
To your great kindness given to all.

Please be seated for the Postlude

Postlude
Dr. Christoph Bull, Organist-in-Residence

One License: A-741625 | CCLI: 2052172

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Southern California Nevada Conference
UCC Annual Gathering
We are the Ones



30 May 2026



“Resurrection” by Alma Thomas
White House Collection

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of Los Angeles

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